

SAMUEL WEINBERGER

User Experience Research Engineer | AI-Driven Insights

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EDUCATION

Claremont Graduate University

2016–2020

Ph.D. Candidate, Cognitive & Social Psychology; M.A. Psychology (GPA 3.45)

University of Southern California

2008–2010

B.A. Public Policy & Evaluation (GPA 3.65)

Stanford University

2006–2008

Communications & Media Studies (GPA 3.88)

Athletics: NCAA D1 Football (Stanford) • NCAA D1 Baseball (USC) • Team USA, Track Cycling

METHODS & SKILLS

Qualitative Methods

Usability Testing, Field Research, Moderated Interviews, Cognitive Walkthroughs & Task Analysis, Longitudinal Diary Studies

Causal Inference & Advanced Quant

MaxDiff & Surveys, A/B & Multivariate Experimentation, Quasi-Experimental Design (PSM, RD), Survival Analysis & Churn Modeling, Behavioral Segmentation, Concept Testing & Benchmarking

Psychometrics & Behavioral Science

Scale Development & Validation, Behavioral-Economics Nudge Testing, Implicit Association Testing

AI-Driven Research

Claude & Custom AI Agents, Rapid Prototyping & Live Synthesis, End-to-End Study Automation

UX Engineering & Operations

Custom Telemetry Hooks & Event Tracking, Automated Python/SQL Pipelines & Dashboards, Synthetic User Simulation

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Robinhood — Prediction Markets Team

Feb 2026 – Jul 2026

User Experience Research Engineer

- **Growth & Expansion:** Combined in-depth interviews and behavioral segmentation to identify factors limiting prediction-market engagement; designed and tested solutions that drove an 11% engagement increase in new markets, accounting for ~24% of total trade volume.
- **Retention Strategy:** Diagnosed first-time-user friction driving 7–8 figure monthly losses from abandonment; recommended a messaging strategy that reduced drop-off and recovered ~\$12M in monthly revenue (70% of projected losses).
- **AI Research Automation:** Programmed AI agents supporting UX workflows that produce engineering-ready prototypes, accelerating research cycles from ~20–30 days to one week or less and improving project capacity 4x.

FanDuel Group — Core Products & Experiences

Jan 2024 – Feb 2026

Lead UX Researcher

- **Responsible Gaming:** Built and psychometrically validated a proprietary Responsible Gaming Sentiment Scale and risk-prevention tools, raising the share of users meeting regulatory standards from 78% to 92%.
- **Wallet Optimization:** Diagnosed a 65% drop-off at wallet/banking setup via triangulated mixed-methods research (Amplitude funnel analysis, moderated interviews, large-scale survey), generating a ~\$8M boost in handle from first-time deposits.
- **ACH Adoption:** Identified barriers and developed targeted messaging that improved ACH adoption from 20% to 32%, reducing account takeovers from 7–8% to under 4%.
- **Cross-sell Conversion:** Drove ~150K new Sportsbook customers and a 7-figure monthly revenue increase via recommendations improving promotional offers (e.g., Bet \$5, Get \$200).
- **Team Scaling:** Scaled UX Research from 2 to 32 researchers, delivering 200+ studies annually while directing AI-enabled pipelines that cut project turnaround 75%.

FanDuel Group

Mar 2021 – Dec 2023

Senior UX Researcher

- **Onboarding & Acquisition:** Identified onboarding friction and developed messaging strategies that cut support tickets 30% and reduced annual costs by \$1.2M, helping grow the user base from 1.5M to 20M+.
- **Benchmarking & Competitive Analysis:** Architected a continuous, automated measurement framework (in-app pulse checks, competitive usability testing, behavioral event tracking via custom telemetry hooks) feeding product roadmaps for Casino, Fantasy, Racing, and Sportsbook.

NFL — Fantasy App and NFL+ Team

Jan 2019 – Apr 2021

Senior UX Researcher

- **Fantasy+ Tools:** Led generative and formative research on a small cross-functional team to develop and ship in-app features — converting 45% of users and generating \$920K in revenue.
- **NFL+ Pricing & Packaging:** Evaluated the league's first direct-to-consumer mobile subscription and made recommendations that resulted in 1M+ sign-ups after initial launch.
- **Intel TrueView:** Delivered integration and monetization recommendations for the NFL app / Game Pass highlights, giving NFL Labs and Intel a shared research basis for the next phase of the partnership.
- **Verizon 5G SuperStadium:** Directed usability and in-stadium field research connecting Intel technology and 5G Ultra Wideband, generating recommendations that supported the development of the NFL's VIP Fan Experience.

Claremont Graduate University

Jan 2017 – Sep 2019

Grant Writer & Research Associate

- **Grant Funding & Execution:** Awarded \$200K in institutional grant funding to develop and evaluate mobile-health (mHealth) applications for chronic-disease tracking and preventative behavior change.

Ipsos Healthcare

May 2016 – Sep 2017

User Experience Analyst

- **Medical Device Usability:** Authored the research protocol and ran end-to-end comparative usability testing of a biosimilar insulin pen with patients and clinic nurses, moderating simulated-injection sessions and analyzing behavioral and preference data.
- **Research-to-Commercial Impact:** Reshaped the device-education protocol for diabetes educators and patients — associated with a 27% reduction in device-use errors — and turned session footage into field materials for pharmaceutical reps and educators.